Say it to your boss.

FOR AN EMPLOYEE: A MEETING, A ONE-TO-ONE OR A KICK-OFF

Four things to say

1. **What does success look like?** Is 600 the number for every month, or for the whole quarter?
   Ask for clarity. Ask before you guess.
2. **I see a risk**: one person leaves in November, so we will be four, not five.
   Say it early. Say it today, with a fact.
3. I agree with the goal. The number worries me. Could we **start at** 520?
   Disagree calmly. Agree first. Then give one fact and one option.
4. I need two weeks to learn the new tool. Could you **let me know** if it changes the plan?
   Ask for what you need. Name what you need, and say why.

TOO QUIET

Say the better version out loud first

~~No problem, I can do it.~~	→ I can do it. What does success look like?
~~I will try.~~	→ I can start at 520. Could we review it in four weeks?
~~Fine.~~	→ I agree with the goal. The number worries me.
~~Sorry, I am behind.~~	→ **I see a risk**. Here is what I need to fix it.
~~Nothing is wrong.~~	→ I have one **concern**. Can I tell you today?

Four fears keep people quiet. Test the fear with one small sentence.

WHY WE STAY QUIET

Which fear is it?

1. My boss will be offended.
2. It will hurt my career.
3. I will look weak.
4. I will be the only one.

Ask yourself: has this really happened to me? Many people never test their fear.

MARINA'S GOAL

Score = likely result ÷ goal

600	57% · below the sweet spot
520	66% · in the sweet spot
480	72% · above the sweet spot

Invented numbers, a simple estimate for the lesson: 430 tickets a month with five people, 344 with four.

SAY THE NUMBERS OUT LOUD

Out loud, in English

600	six hundred
344	three hundred forty-four
520	five hundred twenty
60 to 70%	sixty to seventy percent
66%	sixty-six percent

Family 1 needs to
I'd like you to explain the priority. Never "I'd like that you explain".

Let, make, have: no to
Could you let me know? Never "let me to know".

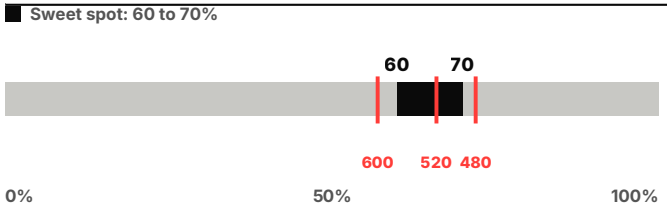
Suggest that + base form
I suggest that we move the date. Never "suggest us to move".

The not
didn't ask them to start · asked them not to start · didn't let them start · suggest that they not start.

Ask. Say. Need.

GOOGLE SCALE

An ambitious goal: the sweet spot



Google says 60 to 70 percent is the sweet spot.

NUMBERS YOU CAN QUOTE

With the source

1980	the year Gabarro and Kotter published "Managing Your Boss" in Harvard Business Review
4 studies	in Detert and Edmondson's 2011 research on why people stay quiet at work
5 kinds	of unspoken rules about speaking up, measured in those studies
180 teams	studied by Google: psychological safety came first of five dynamics

Ask for clarity. Say it early. Disagree calmly. Ask for what you need.

THREE FAMILIES

The patterns

1. **"I'd like you to explain the priority."**
   verb + person + to + verb. ask · need · want · would like · expect
2. **"Could you let me know if the plan changes?"**
   let · make · have + person + verb. Only three verbs. No to after the person.
3. **"I suggest that we move the date by one week."**
   suggest · recommend · propose + that + person + verb. Formal. The verb stays in the base form: that we move, that she join.

WHERE THE NOT GOES

Three places

1. **"I didn't ask them to start." × "I asked them not to start."**
   Two places
2. **"I didn't let them start." Never "I let them not start."**
   The first verb
3. **"I suggest that they not start." Never "that they don't start."**
   After that

BOSS?

Too much for a meeting

~~This goal is stupid.~~	→ **"I am worried about this goal. Can we talk about the date?"**
~~I will do it. Do not worry.~~	→ **"I can do it if I get the data by Monday. I will tell you if there is a risk."**
~~You always change the plan at the last minute.~~	→ **"When the plan changes late, I have little time. Could we agree on a date for changes?"**
~~I need more people, or I will quit.~~	→ **"I need more people to reach this goal. Could we look at the options?"**
~~Sorry, I do not understand anything about this goal.~~	→ **"I understand the goal. I have two questions about the priorities."**

WATCH OUT · FALSE FRIENDS

The word looks Portuguese, but

~~realize~~ realizar	It means to notice or understand. For a goal, say reach or achieve. Say: We reached the goal.
~~assume~~ assumir	It means to suppose something is true. For responsibility, say take responsibility. Say: I take responsibility for the plan.
~~pretend~~ pretender	It means to fake something. For a plan, say intend to. Say: We intend to finish by Friday.
~~support~~ suportar	It means to help. For something hard to bear, say handle or stand. Say: He cannot handle the pressure.
~~compromise~~ compromisso	A compromise is an agreement in which each side gives something up. For a duty or a promise, say commitment.